Prepared 6 Nov 2026 · every figure is computed from the rotas

New CEA link proposals — at a glance

All 22 proposals against today's link — the three shortlisted ones marked ★, and the eight where 14 days' leave buys 30 days off, as today, marked so — sorted by December rules met, then avoidable fatigue warnings, then by name; a proposal that breaks a hard limit cannot be run as it stands and comes last. Every figure is worked out from the rota, by the Marylebone Roster app's own checks and the tooling beside them. Staffing levels and Sunday cover confirmed verbally (29 Sep 2026); the 26-line link, 5 cover weeks and a ceiling of 219 contracted days a year set on 1 Oct 2026.

PROPOSAL · CODE	DECEMBER RULES MET	AVOIDABLE FATIGUE WARNINGS§	MOST DAYS IN A ROW§	FULL WEEKENDS OFF	SHORTEST REST BETWEEN SHIFTS§	SHIFT TIMES	DAYS A YEAR*	HEAVIEST WEEK, MON–SAT	WEEKS ON ONE SHIFT TIME, ALL EARLIES OR ALL LATES	WEEKS MIXING EARLIES AND LATES	WEEK-TO-WEEK CHANGE OF START	FINISHES 23:00+ A YEAR†
Today's link 20 weeks	4 of 9	4 up to 5§	7 up to 9§	4 in 20 about 10 a year · 7 weeks apart at most	12h 30m	18	219.0	43h 50m	7 of 16 blocks 2 (up to 3)	7	4h 00m	39
Balanced V5 MB-26-V5 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 4§	5 up to 10§	6 in 26 about 12 a year · 6 weeks apart at most	13h 50m	16 (7 new)	218.6	42h 55m	7 of 21 blocks 3 (up to 5)	3	4h 06m	42
Balanced V6 MB-26-V6 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 4§	5 up to 10§	6 in 26 about 12 a year · 6 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	17 (8 new)	218.6	42h 55m	7 of 21 blocks 3 (up to 5)	3	4h 08m	42
Balanced V7 MB-26-V7 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	17 (8 new)	218.6	42h 55m	13 of 21 blocks 3 (up to 5)	3	2h 33m	42
Both Ways BW-26-T3	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	15 (6 new)	218.6	41h 20m	16 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 40m	42
Clean Slate CS-26-N2	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	16 (10 new)	218.6	42h 00m	19 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 21m	42
Closing Time CT-26-T2	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	13 (6 new)	218.6	42h 00m	17 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 10m	42
Common Ground CG-26-T8 ★ shortlisted 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	13 (6 new)	218.6	42h 30m	19 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 12m	42
Even Keel EK-26-H1	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	15 (7 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 12)	1	1h 16m	44
Even Step ES-26-T5 ★ shortlisted	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	13 (6 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 31m	42
Fair Share FS-26-T7	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	16 (9 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 18m	42
Fine Tune FT-26-H1	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	15 (7 new)	218.6	42h 00m	16 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 12)	1	1h 10m	44
Grand Tour GT-26-T7 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	16 (9 new)	218.6	42h 00m	16 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 16m	42
Home Grown HG-26-T1	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	13 (4 new)	218.6	42h 30m	16 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 25m	42
In Step IS-26-T4	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	15 (7 new)	218.6	41h 05m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 13m	42
Long Break LB-26-F1	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	6 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	15 (7 new)	218.6	42h 00m	16 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 9)	0	1h 44m	42
Middle Ground MG-26-T8 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	13 (6 new)	218.6	42h 30m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 41m	42
Next Step NS-26-T6	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	14 (7 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 18m	42
Open Return OR-26-EXT 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 0§	5 up to 6§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	13h 15m	16 (9 new)	218.6	43h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 17m	42
Second Edition SE-26-F1	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	6 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	15 (7 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 01m	42
Second Look SL-26-G3	9 of 9	0 up to 0§	6 up to 6§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	14 (7 new)	218.6	43h 40m	15 of 21 blocks 4 (up to 6)	1	1h 30m	42
Short Openers SO-26-EXT 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 0§	5 up to 6§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	13h 15m	14 (7 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 12m	42
Short Run SR-26-F1 ★ shortlisted	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	15 (7 new)	218.6	42h 30m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 13m	42

* Monday to Saturday, with a cover week counted as 4 days (Sundays are overtime and left out). † Each person, on average across the whole link, Sundays included; cover-week duties are not known yet and are left out. "Shift times" counts different start–finish times; "new" means nobody works that time today.

"Weeks on one shift time" means one shift time Monday to Friday, all earlies or all lates; beneath it, the longest block of weeks in a row on one kind, "up to" if the cover weeks beside it go the same way. The week-to-week change is the average move of the start time from one week to the next.

§ On the duties the rota fixes, the cover weeks left out for the proposal and today alike; "up to" is the worst place a cover week's four duties could fall, its Sunday worked as overtime. Avoidable fatigue warnings come from the ORR's good-practice list plus rail-industry checks, leaving out the two that come with the station and the link — the 06:20 open and a weekly rotation — and are reported, never pass or fail.

Full detail for each proposal is in its own eight-page sheet; the rules themselves are in links-26-rules.pdf.